

Five Useful Kitchen Hacks

Simple habits that help home cooks work safely, confidently and with less waste.

1. Prepare before heating

Read the recipe, collect ingredients and prepare equipment before switching on the cooker.

2. Stabilise the chopping board

Place a damp folded cloth beneath the board to reduce movement while chopping.

3. Keep herbs fresh

Wrap clean herbs in a slightly damp kitchen towel and store them in a covered container in the fridge.

4. Save useful scraps

Freeze clean vegetable trimmings such as carrot ends and herb stems, then use them to make stock.

5. Taste as you cook

Taste at sensible stages and season gradually. It is easier to add more seasoning than remove it.

Safety reminder: use heatproof gloves, keep knife blades sharp and stable, and never leave hot oil unattended.